Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 2: Oceans and Continents

Book: Exploring Society: India and Beyond | CBSE | Answers in simple English

इस अध्याय के PDF में दिए गए सभी textbook questions, activities, important definitions और प्रत्येक topic से संभावित परीक्षा-उपयोगी प्रश्नों के उत्तर नीचे दिए गए हैं। उत्तर सरल अंग्रेज़ी में रखे गए हैं ताकि विद्यार्थी उन्हें आसानी से समझ सकें और परीक्षा में लिख सकें।

Topic 1: The Earth, Oceans and Continents

Q1. Why is the Earth called the Blue Planet?

Answer: The Earth is called the Blue Planet because almost three-fourths of its surface is covered with water. It appears blue when seen from outer space.

Q2. What are oceans?

Answer: Oceans are the largest bodies of water on the Earth.

Q3. What is a landmass?

Answer: A landmass is a large body of land.

Q4. What is a continent?

Answer: A continent is a large and continuous expanse of land.

Q5. How much of the Earth's surface is covered with water?

Answer: Almost three-fourths of the Earth's surface is covered with water.

Q6. How much of the Earth's surface is covered with land?

Answer: A little more than one-fourth of the Earth's surface is covered with land.

Q7. Why are oceans and continents important?

Answer: Oceans and continents affect the Earth's climate and influence the lives of plants, animals, and human beings. They also affect our history, culture, and daily life.

Q8. What does the photograph of the Earth on page 27 show?

Answer: It shows the Earth from space, with the Indian Ocean in the centre, Africa to the left, India and Asia at the top, Australia to the right, and Antarctica at the bottom.

Q9. What is the meaning of the Indian Navy's motto, “Sam noh Varunah”?

Answer: It means, “Be auspicious to us, O Varuna.” Varuna is a Vedic deity associated with the oceans, the sky, and water.

Topic 2: Distribution of Water and Land on the Earth

Q10. Are land and water equally distributed between the two hemispheres?

Answer: No. The Northern and Southern Hemispheres do not have equal amounts of land and water.

Q11. Which hemisphere has more land?

Answer: The Northern Hemisphere has more land than the Southern Hemisphere.

Q12. Which hemisphere has more water?

Answer: The Southern Hemisphere has more water than the Northern Hemisphere.

Q13. What are seas, bays, and gulfs?

Answer: They are smaller extensions or parts of ocean waters. They have different shapes and locations along the coasts and within land areas.

Q14. Are all oceans connected to one another?

Answer: Yes. The oceans are interconnected. Seawater flows continuously between them, although maps show conventional boundaries.

Q15. What are the circular lines and radiating lines shown in Figure 2.2 on page 29?

Answer: The circular lines represent parallels of latitude, and the lines radiating from the poles represent meridians of longitude.

Q16. What is the main conclusion from the maps shown on page 29?

Answer: The maps show that land and water are unevenly distributed between the Northern and Southern Hemispheres. The Southern Hemisphere contains more water.

Topic 3: Freshwater and Saltwater

Q17. Why is ocean water not suitable for drinking?

Answer: Ocean water contains a large amount of salt. Therefore, it is not suitable for drinking without desalination.

Q18. Where is freshwater found on the Earth?

Answer: Freshwater is found in glaciers, rivers, lakes, the atmosphere, and underground as groundwater.

Q19. What is groundwater?

Answer: Groundwater is water found beneath the Earth's surface.

Q20. Why is there a water crisis when the Earth has so much water?

Answer: Most of the Earth's water is salty ocean water. Only a small proportion is freshwater, and not all freshwater is easily available for human use.

Q21. How can we save water at home and at school?

Answer: We can save water by closing taps properly, repairing leaks, using water carefully, collecting rainwater, and reusing water whenever possible.

Q22. What is water scarcity?

Answer: Water scarcity is a situation in which there is not enough usable water to meet people's needs.

Topic 4: The Five Oceans

The world map in Figure 2.3 on page 32 shows the five oceans and the seven continents.

Q23. Name the five oceans of the Earth.

Answer:

1. Pacific Ocean
2. Atlantic Ocean
3. Indian Ocean
4. Southern Ocean
5. Arctic Ocean

Q24. Which is the largest ocean?

Answer: The Pacific Ocean is the largest ocean.

Q25. Which is the second-largest ocean?

Answer: The Atlantic Ocean is the second-largest ocean.

Q26. Which is the third-largest ocean?

Answer: The Indian Ocean is the third-largest ocean.

Q27. Which is the fourth-largest ocean?

Answer: The Southern Ocean is the fourth-largest ocean.

Q28. Which is the smallest ocean?

Answer: The Arctic Ocean is the smallest ocean.

Q29. Are the five oceans naturally separated from one another?

Answer: No. The oceans are interconnected. Their boundaries on maps are conventional lines.

Q30. What is marine life?

Answer: Marine life includes the plants and animals that live in seas and oceans.

Q31. What are marine flora and marine fauna?

Answer: Marine flora means plant life in the oceans, such as algae and seaweeds. Marine fauna means animal life in the oceans, such as fish, dolphins, and whales.

Q32. Name some animals that live in oceans.

Answer: Sharks, dolphins, whales, sea turtles, starfish, and many kinds of fish live in oceans.

Q33. Why is ocean life diverse?

Answer: Different parts of the oceans have different conditions, from sunlit surface waters to dark deep waters. These conditions support many different forms of life.

Topic 5: Oceans and Disasters

Q34. How do oceans bring rain to continents?

Answer: Water evaporates from the oceans and forms clouds. These clouds bring rain to the continents. The monsoon rains in India originate from moisture carried from the oceans.

Q35. What is a storm?

Answer: A storm is a violent weather event that may bring heavy rainfall and very strong winds.

Q36. What is a cyclone?

Answer: A cyclone is a powerful storm with strong winds and often heavy rainfall. It can cause serious damage to coastal areas.

Q37. What is a tsunami?

Answer: A tsunami is a series of huge and powerful sea waves, generally caused by a strong underwater earthquake or a volcanic eruption at the bottom of the ocean.

Q38. How can a tsunami cause damage?

Answer: A tsunami can flood coastal areas, destroy buildings, damage roads, and cause loss of life and property.

Q39. What happened on 26 December 2004?

Answer: A powerful tsunami caused by an earthquake in Indonesia struck India and 13 other countries around the Indian Ocean. More than two lakh people lost their lives. India's Andaman and Nicobar Islands and the coasts of Tamil Nadu and Kerala were severely affected.

Q40. What is an early warning system?

Answer: An early warning system detects or predicts a possible disaster and warns people before it strikes. It helps people take protective measures.

Q41. What is disaster management?

Answer: Disaster management includes the planning and actions taken to reduce the damage caused by disasters and to protect lives and property.

Q42. Which organisation in India deals with disasters?

Answer: The National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) deals with disaster management in India.

Q43. Can tsunamis be detected before they reach a coast?

Answer: Yes. Tsunamis can often be detected through warning systems, giving people time to move to safer places.

Topic 6: Continents

Q44. How many continents are commonly recognised?

Answer: Seven continents are most commonly recognised.

Q45. Name the seven continents.

Answer:

1. Asia
2. Africa
3. North America
4. South America
5. Antarctica
6. Europe
7. Australia

Q46. Which is the largest continent?

Answer: Asia is the largest continent.

Q47. Which is the smallest continent?

Answer: Australia is the smallest continent in the seven-continent model used in the textbook.

Q48. Which is the coldest continent?

Answer: Antarctica is the coldest continent.

Q49. Why can the number of continents vary?

Answer: Continents can be grouped in different ways. For example, North and South America can be considered one landmass, while Europe and Asia can be grouped together as Eurasia.

Q50. What is Eurasia?

Answer: Eurasia is the single large landmass formed by Europe and Asia.

Q51. Why are Europe and Asia generally considered separate continents?

Answer: They are generally considered separate for historical and cultural reasons, even though they form one continuous landmass.

Q52. How can Africa and Eurasia be counted?

Answer: They are generally counted as two continents, but sometimes they are treated as one.

Q53. What are the four-, five-, six-, and seven-continent models?

Answer: The textbook presents these ways of counting continents:

Model	Continents
Four continents	Africa-Eurasia, America, Antarctica, Australia
Five continents	Africa, America, Antarctica, Australia, Eurasia
Six continents	Africa, Antarctica, Australia, Eurasia, North America, South America
Seven continents	Africa, Antarctica, Asia, Australia, Europe, North America, South America

Q54. Which continent model is most widely used?

Answer: The seven-continent model is the most widely used.

Q55. What do the five Olympic rings represent according to the textbook?

Answer: They represent five inhabited continents: Africa, America, Asia, Australia, and Europe.

Topic 7: Islands

Q56. What is an island?

Answer: An island is a piece of land surrounded by water on all sides. It is smaller than a continent.

Q57. Which is the largest island in the world?

Answer: Greenland is the largest island in the world.

Q58. Name the two major groups of Indian islands.

Answer:

1. Andaman and Nicobar Islands
2. Lakshadweep Islands

Q59. Where are the Andaman and Nicobar Islands located?

Answer: They are located in the Bay of Bengal.

Q60. Where are the Lakshadweep Islands located?

Answer: They are located in the Arabian Sea.

Q61. How many small islands does India have, according to the textbook?

Answer: The textbook states that India has more than 1,300 small islands.

Q62. What is the Indian Antarctica Programme?

Answer: It is India's scientific programme for exploring and studying Antarctica, including its climate and environment.

Q63. What was Dakshin Gangotri?

Answer: Dakshin Gangotri was India's first scientific base station in Antarctica, established in 1983.

Q64. Why do Indian scientists study Antarctica?

Answer: They study Antarctica to understand the climate, the environment, and how they have changed over time.

Topic 8: Oceans and Life

Q65. Why are oceans important for rainfall?

Answer: Oceans provide water vapour through evaporation. This water vapour forms clouds and helps produce rainfall on land.

Q66. Why are oceans called the lungs of the planet?

Answer: According to the textbook, ocean flora produces more than half of the world's oxygen. Therefore, oceans are called the lungs of the planet.

Q67. How do oceans regulate the Earth's climate?

Answer: Oceans absorb, store, and distribute heat and influence rainfall and weather patterns. They help regulate the Earth's climate.

Q68. How have oceans helped human beings throughout history?

Answer: People have used oceans for migration, trade, fishing, and military campaigns. Oceans have also influenced the cultures and traditions of coastal communities.

Q69. Why are oceans important as a source of food?

Answer: Oceans provide fish and other marine organisms that people use as food.

Q70. What is World Oceans Day?

Answer: World Oceans Day is observed on 8 June to remind people of the importance of oceans and the need to protect them.

Q71. How do humans pollute the oceans?

Answer: Humans pollute oceans by dumping plastic waste, other rubbish, and harmful substances into the water.

Q72. What is overfishing?

Answer: Overfishing means catching fish in excessive quantities, which can reduce fish populations and harm marine life.

Q73. Why should we protect oceans?

Answer: We should protect oceans because they support marine life, produce oxygen, influence climate, provide food, and help sustain life on Earth.

Q74. How can we protect oceans?

Answer: We can protect oceans by reducing plastic waste, preventing pollution, avoiding excessive fishing, and supporting marine conservation.

Part E: All textbook questions and activities

Question 1. Explain the following terms.

(a) Continent

Answer: A continent is a large and continuous expanse of land.

(b) Ocean

Answer: An ocean is a vast body of salt water covering a large part of the Earth's surface.

(c) Island

Answer: An island is a piece of land surrounded by water on all sides.

Question 2. Draw the continents freehand and colour them.

Answer: This is a drawing activity. Draw the seven continents on a sheet of paper and colour them differently. Then compare your drawing with Figure 2.3 on page 32 of the textbook.

Remember the names: Asia, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Europe, and Australia.

Question 3. Label all the continents and oceans on the outline map.

Use the following names to label the world map on page 39.

Continents:

- Asia
- Africa
- North America
- South America
- Antarctica
- Europe
- Australia

Oceans:

- Pacific Ocean
- Atlantic Ocean
- Indian Ocean
- Southern Ocean
- Arctic Ocean

Map tip: The Arctic Ocean is around the North Pole, while the Southern Ocean surrounds Antarctica. The Indian Ocean lies between Africa, Asia, and Australia. The Pacific Ocean lies between Asia/Australia and the Americas.

Question 4. Solve the crossword (page 40)

The answers to the crossword clues are:

Direction	No.	Clue	Answer
Across	1	Abundantly produced by the oceans	Oxygen
Across	3	A large expanse of landmass	Continent
Across	6	A large continent of which India is a part	Asia
Across	8	A major source of pollution of the oceans	Plastic
Across	10	The coldest continent	Antarctica
Down	2	The largest island on Earth	Greenland
Down	4	A huge destructive wave from the ocean	Tsunami
Down	5	The smallest continent	Australia

Down	7	The largest body of water on the Earth	Ocean
Down	9	A landmass surrounded by water, but not a continent	Island

Part F: Additional textbook activities

Q1. Which hemisphere has more water?

Answer: The Southern Hemisphere has more water than the Northern Hemisphere.

Q2. Which oceans lie in the Northern and Southern Hemispheres?

Answer:

Ocean	Northern Hemisphere	Southern Hemisphere
Pacific Ocean	Yes	Yes
Atlantic Ocean	Yes	Yes
Indian Ocean	Yes	Yes
Southern Ocean	No	Yes
Arctic Ocean	Yes	No

Q3. Which continent is larger: North America or South America?

Answer: North America is larger than South America.

Q4. Which is larger: Africa or North America?

Answer: Africa is larger than North America.

Q5. Which is larger: Antarctica or Australia?

Answer: Antarctica is larger than Australia.

Q6. Arrange the continents from smallest to largest.

Answer:

1. Australia
2. Europe
3. Antarctica
4. South America
5. North America
6. Africa
7. Asia

Q7. If Europe and Asia are joined together, what is the result called?

Answer: The resulting landmass is called Eurasia. It is larger than South America.

Q8. Why is freshwater important?

Answer: Freshwater is essential for drinking, agriculture, sanitation, and the survival of plants and animals. Although the Earth has abundant water, only a small proportion is freshwater.

Q9. Why are coastal communities closely connected with oceans?

Answer: Oceans provide food, transport routes, trade opportunities, and livelihoods. They also influence the traditions, stories, and culture of coastal communities.

Q10. What is the main message of this chapter?

Answer: Oceans and continents shape the Earth's climate and support life. Oceans provide oxygen, food, rainfall, and transport routes, but pollution and overfishing threaten them. We must protect oceans and use natural resources responsibly.

Final revision: Important facts to memorise



Earth

Almost 3/4 water

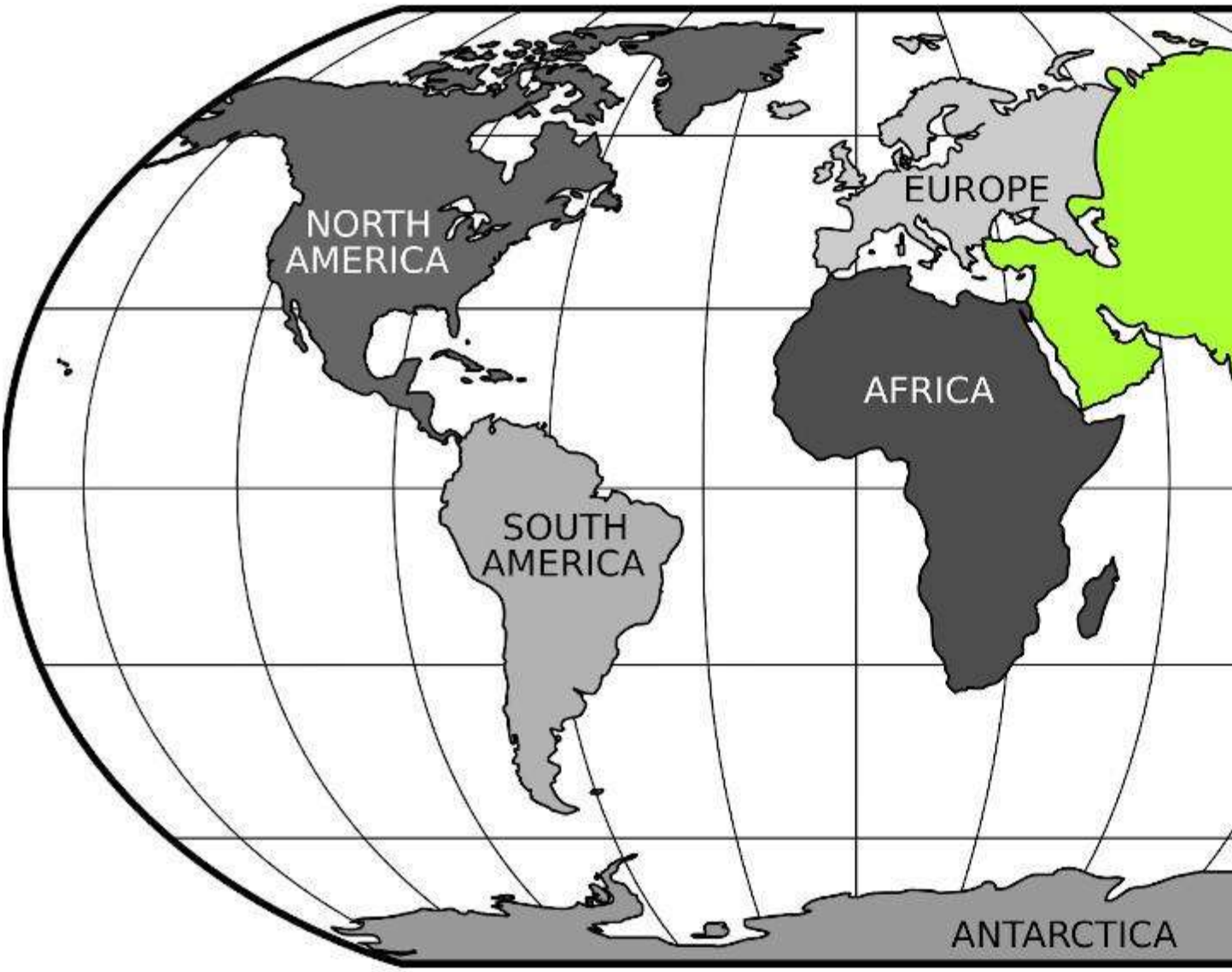
The Earth is known as the Blue Planet.



Oceans

Largest: Pacific Ocean

Smallest: Arctic Ocean



Continents

Largest: Asia

Smallest: Australia

Coldest: Antarctica



Islands

Largest island: Greenland

Indian island groups: Andaman and Nicobar; Lakshadweep



Ocean protection

World Oceans Day: 8 June

Major threats: plastic pollution and overfishing

Exam tip: Learn the definitions, the names and order of the oceans and continents, the difference between oceans and continents, the causes of tsunamis, and the importance of oceans. Also practise labelling the world map because the chapter includes a map activity.